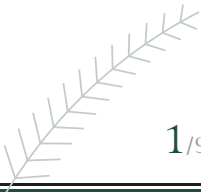


This Christmas.



THE SHAPE OF IT

Christmas Day at

Who is there

Adults Children

Staying over

Travelling on

Christmas Eve is

Boxing Day is

MONEY, DECIDED NOW A number written down is spent slo...

Gifts Food & drink

Travel Everything else

All of it, and not a penny more

WHO DOES WHAT Christmas is not one person's job

THE JOB WHOSE

Presents

Food shopping

Cooking on the day

Cards and post

Washing up

What we are not doing this year

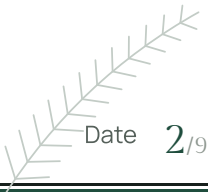
Fill this in before anything else. Christmas gets heavy because everything from every previous year is still on the list. Name three things you are dropping – a card to everyone, a second pudding, the drive on the day – and the rest of this kit gets easier.

THE ONE THING THAT HAS TO BE RIGHT

BOOKED, ORDERED, PAID FOR Anything with a date o...

TRADITIONS WORTH KEEPING

December, day by day.



THE TWENTY-FIVE ————— Most days should stay empty

1	☐
2	☐
3	☐
4	☐
5	☐
6	☐
7	☐
8	☐
9	☐
10	☐
11	☐
12	☐
13	☐
14	☐
15	☐
16	☐
17	☐
18	☐
19	☐
20	☐
21	☐
22	☐
23	☐
24	☐
25	☐

DATES THAT ARE NOT YOURS TO MOVE ————— Look them up o...

Last post, second class	☐
Last post, first class	☐
Last post, overseas	☐
Food order placed	☐
Food order collected	☐
School / work ends	☐
Tree up	☐
Guests arrive	☐

The posting dates are the real deadline

Cards and parcels are the one part of Christmas that cannot be done late. Find this year's last posting dates in the first week of December, write them above, and work back from them — not from the twenty-fifth.

ORDERED, NOT BOUGHT — Turkey, ham, a cake, a case of wine

☐	
☐	
☐	
☐	
☐	

NOBODY HAS CLAIMED THESE YET —————

Fill the budget column first, before you buy anything

December, written down.

Overseas first – they leave weeks earlier

WRIT POST

[illegible]

GONE

- ☐ Cards, and six more than you think
- ☐ Stamps – two sizes, and overseas ones
- ☐ Addresses, from last year's envelopes
- ☐ Tape, tags, and paper that is not glittery
- ☐ A pen that does not smudge

What we are eating.

THE MEAL

Who makes it, not just what it is

DISH

WHO

GOT

		☐
		☐
		☐
		☐
		☐
		☐
		☐
		☐
		☐
		☐

PUDDING, CHEESE, CHOCOLATE

		☐
		☐
		☐
		☐
		☐

THE BITS NOBODY REMEMBERS

- ☐ Bread, butter, gravy, sauces
- ☐ Milk and cream – twice what you think
- ☐ Foil, cling film, freezer bags for the leftovers
- ☐ A proper meal for whoever eats no meat

DRINK

Count the non-drinkers too

		☐
		☐
		☐
		☐
		☐

WHO CANNOT EAT WHAT

Ask now, not on the day

		☐
		☐
		☐
		☐

BUY EARLY, IT KEEPS

☐	
☐	
☐	
☐	

BUY ON THE LAST DAY, IT WILL NOT

☐	
☐	
☐	

Write this first. Everything below counts back from it.

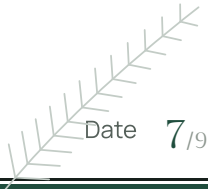
DISH	TEMP	MINS	IN AT	OUT AT	✓
------	------	------	-------	--------	---

[illegible]

Start with the thing that takes longest and the thing that must rest. Write its **out at** time, subtract the minutes, and you have **in at**. Then fit everything else around it. Two dishes wanting different temperatures at the same time is the problem you want to find today, not on the day.

Rests from To

The house, and the beds.



ROOM BY ROOM One idea each is plenty

WHERE	WHAT GOES THERE	DONE
Tree		☐
Front door		☐
Hall		☐
Living room		☐
Table		☐
Kitchen		☐
Spare room		☐

THE TREE

Bought on Up on

- ☐ Lights tested before they go on
- ☐ Water it – a real tree drinks daily
- ☐ Nothing breakable at toddler or dog height

THE THINGS THAT GO MISSING EVERY YEAR

- ☐ The stockings
- ☐ Spare bulbs and fuses for the lights
- ☐ The good tablecloth and the napkins
- ☐ Crackers, and somewhere to hide them
- ☐ The tree stand

WHO IS SLEEPING WHERE

WHO	WHERE	BED	TWL
		☐	☐
		☐	☐
		☐	☐
		☐	☐
		☐	☐

THINGS GUESTS ALWAYS NEED AND NEVER BRING

- ☐ A spare toothbrush and toothpaste
- ☐ A phone charger by the bed
- ☐ An extra blanket, and where the heating is
- ☐ Somewhere to put a suitcase down

WHERE THE BOXES LIVE Thank yourself in January

DONE BEFORE THE DOORBELL

- ☐
- ☐
- ☐

Only the things that need a time

WHO IS ON IT

Write the time next to each

- 1 **Awake, and the first cup of tea**
Before the first present, not after
- 2 **Presents**
Slower than anyone wants; someone collects the paper
- 3 **Breakfast that is not the lunch**
Otherwise nobody eats until four
- 4 **Kitchen closes to visitors**
One cook, one helper, everyone else out
- 5 **Lunch**
The time from page 6, said out loud the night before
- 6 **The walk, or the quiet hour**
The part people remember
- 7 **Calls to whoever is not here**
Put a time on it or it slips
- 8 **Games, film, leftovers**
Nothing more is cooked today

The week after.

RETURNS ——— Most shops give until mid-January — but check

WHAT	FROM	BY WHEN	DONE
			☐
			☐
			☐
			☐
			☐
			☐

THANK-YOUS OWED ——— Let the children write their own

TO	FOR	SENT
		☐
		☐
		☐
		☐
		☐
		☐
		☐

Buy next year's Christmas this week

Cards, paper, crackers, lights and decorations are half price from the twenty-seventh. Buy them now, put them in one labelled box with the decorations, and write on the lid what is inside. It is the cheapest hour you will spend on next Christmas.

BOUGHT IN THE SALES, IN THE BOX ———

☐

☐

☐

☐

WHAT WE SPENT, HONESTLY ———

Planned

Actual

KEEP, CHANGE, DROP ——— Before you forget